SSC CHSL 2021 Tier-I question paper with answers

26 May 2022 · Shift 3

83 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 17 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20220816140307/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2021_16082022.pdf

English Language 23 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. In order to win the competition, one has to be “creative”.

(A) most creative
(B) more creative
(C) creativest
(D) creativer

Q.2

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Eternal; lasting forever or indefinitely

(A) Peristyle
(B) Perpetual
(C) Perplex
(D) Permissive

Q.3

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Cavalier
(B) Elegant
(C) Charishma
(D) Dominate

Q.4

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underline segment in the given sentence. The Ukranian soldiers “passed in” for several weeks.

(A) hanged to
(B) get off
(C) held out
(D) hanged in

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. We should _____ his outfit as he has put on weight.

(A) alter
(B) altar
(C) ultra
(D) utter

Q.6

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Sanguinity

(A) Acrimony
(B) Despondence
(C) Optimism
(D) Distrust

Q.7

Select the correct homonym from the given options to fill in the blank. The French perfume has a wonderful_____

(A) sent
(B) send
(C) scent
(D) cent

Q.8

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice. The new bride is going to be admired by everyone in the family.

(A) Everybody in the family is going to admire the new bride.
(B) Everybody in the family was admiring the new bride.
(C) Everybody in the family has been going to admire the new bride.
(D) Everybody in the family was going to admire the new bride.

Q.9

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the underlined group of words. Mohan frequently “wastes his money on luxurious objects” such as cars and digital devices.

(A) Extravagant
(B) Businessman
(C) Consumer
(D) Capitalist

Q.10

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Safe pair of hands

(A) Miss an opportunity
(B) Speak rashly without thinking carefully
(C) A secret or hidden advantage
(D) A person who can be trusted to do something efficiently

Q.11

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. An outlook that is influenced by people from all over the world

(A) Cosmopolitan
(B) Epitome
(C) Unrefined
(D) Cantonment

Q.12

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice. Admittance was refused to him by the airport security.

(A) The airport security is refusing him admittance.
(B) The airport security has refused him admittance.
(C) The airport security had refused him admittance.
(D) The airport security refused him admittance.

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. I told Pooja “that she could have use my car to get around” while she is in my hometown.

(A) that she could have use my car to get around with
(B) that she can use my car to get around
(C) that she could have use my car to get away
(D) that she can use my car to get away with

Q.16

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. The government presented awards to eminent people.

(A) Eminent people were presented awards by the government.
(B) Eminent people are presented awards by the government.
(C) Eminent people are being presented awards by the government.
(D) Eminent people were being presented awards by the government.

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined word in the given sentence. Due to his hard work, he established a “succesful” career.

(A) successful
(B) sucessful
(C) sucessfful
(D) sucessfull

Q.18

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. Dumbledore tells McGonagall that someone named Voldemort has killed a Mr. and Mrs. Potter and tried unsuccessfully to kill their baby son, Harry. B. Dumbledore leaves Harry with an explanatory note in a basket in front of the Dursley home. C. Mr. Dursley, a well-off Englishman, notices strange happenings on his way to work one day. D. That night, Albus Dumbledore, the head of a wizardry academy called Hogwarts, meets Professor McGonagall, who also teaches at Hogwarts, and a giant named Hagrid outside the Dursley home.

(A) BCAD
(B) DCAB
(C) ADBC
(D) CDAB

Q.19

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word. We “expended” most of our savings on this tour.

(A) exhausted
(B) earned
(C) enjoyed
(D) encashed

Q.20

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Let down

(A) To hire
(B) To care about
(C) To fail
(D) To nurse

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Trust is (1) _____ confidence, faith and hope in someone or something. There are many ways to show trust. If you want to be trusted, just be (2)_____. Trust takes years to build, seconds to (3) _____ and forever to repair. Trust is like a mirror you can fix if (4) _____ but still see the cracks in that reflection. Whether it is a friendship or a relationship, all (5)_____ are based on trust.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) bonding
(B) showing
(C) using
(D) choosing

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Trust is (1) _____ confidence, faith and hope in someone or something. There are many ways to show trust. If you want to be trusted, just be (2)_____. Trust takes years to build, seconds to (3) _____ and forever to repair. Trust is like a mirror you can fix if (4) _____ but still see the cracks in that reflection. Whether it is a friendship or a relationship, all (5)_____ are based on trust.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) calm
(B) honest
(C) extraordinary
(D) heroic

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Trust is (1) _____ confidence, faith and hope in someone or something. There are many ways to show trust. If you want to be trusted, just be (2)_____. Trust takes years to build, seconds to (3) _____ and forever to repair. Trust is like a mirror you can fix if (4) _____ but still see the cracks in that reflection. Whether it is a friendship or a relationship, all (5)_____ are based on trust.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) crack
(B) change
(C) break
(D) burst

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Trust is (1) _____ confidence, faith and hope in someone or something. There are many ways to show trust. If you want to be trusted, just be (2)_____. Trust takes years to build, seconds to (3) _____ and forever to repair. Trust is like a mirror you can fix if (4) _____ but still see the cracks in that reflection. Whether it is a friendship or a relationship, all (5)_____ are based on trust.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) broken
(B) bent
(C) changed
(D) mended

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Trust is (1) _____ confidence, faith and hope in someone or something. There are many ways to show trust. If you want to be trusted, just be (2)_____. Trust takes years to build, seconds to (3) _____ and forever to repair. Trust is like a mirror you can fix if (4) _____ but still see the cracks in that reflection. Whether it is a friendship or a relationship, all (5)_____ are based on trust.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) strategies
(B) tricks
(C) practices
(D) bonds

General Intelligence 19 questions

Q.2

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. SOCCER : OSFFRE :: ROLLER : OROORE :: TOPPER : ?

(A) TOERPK
(B) OTSSRE
(C) OTPPRE
(D) TOSSRE

Q.3

If P denotes '×', Q denotes '÷', R denotes '+' and S denotes '–', then what will come in place of '?' in the following equation? (40 Q 4) P 5 R (3 P 6) S (7 P 8) R 21 = ?

(A) 33
(B) 30
(C) 40
(D) 35

Q.5

Select the option that is related to the third term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the sixth term is related to the fifth term. 5 : 14 :: 12 : ? :: 17 : 86

(A) 51
(B) 56
(C) 67
(D) 63

Q.6

In a certain code language, 'HELP' is written as '1652432' and 'SAVE' is written as '381445'. How will 'MAIL' be written in that language?

(A) 261926
(B) 261924
(C) 261934
(D) 261928

Q.7

The second number in the given number pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) are followed in all the number pairs except one. Find that odd number pair.

(A) 13 : 28.5
(B) 15 : 32.5
(C) 19 : 38.5
(D) 17 : 35.5

Q.8

R is the brother of N. R is the only son of K. S is the only daughter-in-law of K. How is N related to S?

(A) Sister
(B) Daughter
(C) Mother
(D) Husband’s sister

Q.9

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (56, 8, 15) (32, 16, 18) (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is NOT allowed)

(A) (75, 5, 15)
(B) (70, 5, 13)
(C) (66, 6, 17)
(D) (68, 4, 17)

Q.11

Three Statements are given followed by Three conclusions numbered I, II and III. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All ants are beetles. No beetle is a frog. Some frogs are bugs. Conclusions: I. Some bugs are ants. II. No bug is a beetle. III. No frog is an ant.

(A) Both conclusions I and II follow.
(B) Only conclusion III follows.
(C) Only conclusion I follows.
(D) Both conclusions I and III follow.

Q.12

The second number in the given number-pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) are followed in all the number-pairs EXCEPT one. Find that odd number-pair.

(A) 25 : 3
(B) 64 : 6
(C) 100 : 9
(D) 81 : 7

Q.15

In a certain code language, 'WAVE' is coded as ‘426522’ and ‘SOUND’ is coded as ’81261323’. How will 'LIGHT' be coded in that language?

(A) 131820197
(B) 151820197
(C) 151820166
(D) 151880197

Q.16

The birth date of Viaan is 9 March 2002. Find the day of the week of that day.

(A) Saturday
(B) Tuesday
(C) Monday
(D) Friday

Q.17

Which letter-cluster will replace the question mark (?) to complete the given series? TBNF, CJUL, LRBR, UZIX, ?

(A) CHPC
(B) DHPC
(C) CHPD
(D) DHPD

Q.18

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 39*4*61*18*4*49*7*30

(A) +,−,=,×,−,+,÷
(B) +,−,=,×,−,×,+
(C) ×,−,=, ×,−,÷,+
(D) =,−,+,×,−,÷,−

Q.19

Study the given pattern carefully and select the number that can replace the question mark (?) in it. First row: 17, 26, 60; Second row:8, 15, 31; Third row: 11, 19, ? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the number into its constituent digits. For example, 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/deleting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 52
(B) 41
(C) 48
(D) 50

Q.20

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 50 * 2 * 3 * 30 * 10 * 40 * 20

(A) =, ×, ×, +, −, ÷
(B) −, ÷, ×, ×, =, ×
(C) =, ×, +, ×, −, ÷
(D) ×, =, ×, ×, −, ×

Q.21

The second number in the given number pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) are followed in all the number pairs, EXCEPT one. Find that odd number pair.

(A) 24 : 8
(B) 16 : 4
(C) 48 : 12
(D) 20 : 5

Q.22

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 23, 28, 280, 295, 5900, ?

(A) 5920
(B) 5935
(C) 5925
(D) 5930

Q.23

In a certain code language, 'DUCK' is written as 'FSEI' and ‘FISH’ is written as ‘HGUF’. How will 'FROG' be written in that language?

(A) HEPQ
(B) HQPE
(C) HPEQ
(D) HPQE

Q.25

Select the option that represents the letters that, when sequentially placed from left to right in the blanks below, will complete the letter series. _ M o N _ _ _ o M _ _ o _ _o M _ N o J o

(A) o o J o o N J o M
(B) o o J o o N J o o
(C) o M J o o N J o o
(D) M o J o o N J o o

Quantitative Aptitude 16 questions

Q.4

The third proportional to 81 and 27 is:

(A) 8
(B) 6
(C) 7
(D) 9

Q.5

The marked price of a study table is ₹3,200. It will be offered for ₹2,448 after two successive discounts. If the first discount is 10%, the second discount is:

(A) 13%
(B) 10%
(C) 15%
(D) 18%

Q.8

In an election between two candidates, 10% of the voters did not cast their vote and 5% of the votes polled were found invalid. The successful candidate got 55% of the valid votes and won by a majority of 1710 votes. How many voters were enrolled?

(A) 20000
(B) 21000
(C) 19000
(D) 20500

Q.9

15 identical solid spherical balls of radius 5 cm are melted to form a single sphere. In this process, 35% of the mass is wasted. What is the radius (in cm) of the single sphere that is now formed? [Use π = 22/7, and give your answer correct to two decimal places.]

(A) 12.68 cm
(B) 16.68 cm
(C) 10.68 cm
(D) 34.68 cm

Q.11

The side of a square is 5 cm. If the side is doubled, by how many times will the area of the square increase?

(A) 3 times
(B) 2 times
(C) 5 times
(D) 4 times

Q.12

A bus goes to Mumbai from Delhi at the speed of 60 km/h for 60% of the journey, and covers the remaining part of its journey at the speed of 70 km/h. What is the average speed of the bus (in km/h) during the entire journey under consideration?

(A) 67
(B) 64
(C) 66
(D) 65

Q.14

A manufacturer sells an item to a wholesale dealer at a profit of 11%. The wholesaler sells the same to a retailer at a profit of 15%. The retailer in turn sells it to a customer for ₹17,045, thereby earning a profit of 19%. The cost price of the manufacturer is (consider integral part only):

(A) ₹13,520
(B) ₹15,020
(C) ₹10,200
(D) ₹11,220

Q.15

In an examination, the average marks of 60 girls is 15 and the average marks of 40 boys is 30. The average marks of the group in which the boys and girls are taken together is:

(A) 15
(B) 21
(C) 24
(D) 60

Q.17

A grocer has a sale of ₹8,435, ₹8,927, ₹8,855, ₹9,230 and ₹8,562 in 5 consecutive weeks. How much sale must he have in the 6th week so that he gets an average sale of ₹8,500?

(A) ₹7009
(B) ₹6997
(C) ₹6991
(D) ₹7011

Q.18

Ram is travelling at a speed of 72 km per hour while Shyam is travelling at a speed of 90 km per hour. What is the difference in their speeds (in metres per second)?

(A) 5
(B) 4
(C) 6
(D) 7

Q.19

A tractor is sold after allowing three successive discounts of 10%, 5% and 2%. If the marked price of the tractor is Rs 4,88,000, find its net selling price.

(A) Rs 5,08,895.2
(B) Rs 4,49,895.06
(C) Rs 4,18,895.45
(D) Rs 4,08,895.2

Q.20

If $a = 2022$, $b = 2021$ and $c = 2020$, then value of $a^2 + b^2 + c^2 - ab - bc - ca$ is:

(A) 2
(B) 4
(C) 3
(D) 1

Q.22

Calculate the difference between the compound interest and the simple interest on a sum of ₹5,000 at the rate of 8% for 3 years. (to nearest ₹)

(A) ₹108
(B) ₹105
(C) ₹102
(D) ₹99

Q.23

Two parallel chords are drawn in a circle of diameter 10 m. The length of one chord is 8 m and the distance between the two chords is 6 m. Find the length of the other chord.

(A) 10 m
(B) 6 m
(C) 4 m
(D) 8 m

Q.24

Evaluate the following expression: $3\tan^2 45° + 2\cos 60° - 2\sin 30°$

(A) 3
(B) 4
(C) 0
(D) 2

Q.25

If the price of rice is raised by 20%, then by what percentage should a person reduce his consumption of rice so that his expenditure remains the same? (correct to one decimal place)

(A) 14.7%
(B) 18.7%
(C) 16.7%
(D) 12.7%

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

Which Indian woman hockey player was made the brand ambassador of the Centre's 'Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao' scheme for Haridwar district in August 2021?

(A) Vandana Katariya
(B) Manpreet Kaur
(C) Rashmita Minz
(D) Rajani Etimarpu

Q.2

What is the distance of the Marathon race?

(A) 42.195 km
(B) 46.195 km
(C) 43.195 km
(D) 44.195 km

Q.3

Which Indian musician won a Grammy twice for Danny Boyle’s film Slumdog Millionaire in 2010?

(A) AR Rahman
(B) Vishal Bharadwaj
(C) Bappi Lahiri
(D) Pritam Chakraborty

Q.4

Who among the following is associated with the Tabla?

(A) Hariprasad Chaurasia
(B) Sultan Khan
(C) Zakir Hussain
(D) Amjad Ali Khan

Q.5

Which element replaced eka aluminium according to the Mendeleev’s periodic table?

(A) Boron
(B) Geranium
(C) Gallium
(D) Sodium

Q.6

In which year was the POSHAN Abhiyaan launched to emphasise the nutritional status of adolescent girls, pregnant women, lactating mothers, and children in the age group of 0-6 years?

(A) 2016
(B) 2019
(C) 2017
(D) 2018

Q.7

Who among the following versatile musicians of India won the Best Music Director National Award for the Hindi movie ‘Rudaali’ and was also known as the ‘Bard of Brahmaputra’?

(A) Bhupen Hazarika
(B) Manas Robin
(C) Joi Barua
(D) Jayanta Hazarika

Q.8

Ashish Sankrityayan is an exponent of _____ music.

(A) Odissi
(B) Dhrupad
(C) Thumri
(D) Kajari

Q.9
Who among the following writers has written the famous Hindi novel 'Godan'?

(A) Mahadevi Verma
(B) Jai Shankar Prasad
(C) Amrita Pritam
(D) Munshi Premchand

Q.10
Who among the following personalities is a Padma Vibhushan, legendary Indian Classical Dancer behind reviving the classical dance form of Odissi in the 20th century?

(A) Surendra Nath Jena
(B) Gangadhar Pradhan
(C) Hare Krishna Behera
(D) Kelucharan Mohapatra

Q.11
Identify the chemical name for Ge.

(A) Gallium
(B) Gold
(C) Germanium
(D) Gadolinium

Q.12
What percentage of the rural population uses safe and functional toilets as per the 2019-20 National Sample Survey report?

(A) 83%
(B) 85%
(C) 82%
(D) 88%

Q.13
The nineteenth century saw the golden age of Kathak under the patronage of Wajid Ali Shah, the last Nawab of _____.

(A) Hyderabad
(B) Rampur
(C) Oudh
(D) Jaunpur

Q.14
The rate at which RBI lends to commercial banks for the short term is called _____.

(A) repo rate
(B) reverse repo rate
(C) bank rate
(D) cash reserve rate

Q.15
Who among the following won Arjuna Award 2021 in Para Archery discipline?

(A) Abhishek Verma
(B) Harvinder Singh
(C) Rishabh Yadav
(D) Aman Saini

Q.16
How many types of writs can be issued by the Supreme Court of India for the protection of Fundamental Rights?

(A) Five
(B) Four
(C) Seven
(D) Six

Q.17
Vannadil Pudiyaveettil Dhananjayan and Shanta Dhananjayan, popularly known as the Dhananjayans were awarded with Rashtriya Kalidas Samman for the year _____.

(A) 2018-19
(B) 2019-20
(C) 2020-21
(D) 2017-18

Q.18
Which Manipuri Classical Dancer opened the ‘Govindji Nartanalaya’ dance school for women in Imphal?

(A) Chandrakanta Singh
(B) Bipin Singh
(C) Senarik Rajkumar
(D) Nileshwar Mukherjee

Q.19
Which of the following was the venue of the first ICC Test Championship final between India and New Zealand?

(A) South Africa
(B) England
(C) New Zealand
(D) India

Q.20
In January 2021, which state/Union Territory issued its ‘School Bag Policy 2020’, according to which the weight of the school bag should be at a maximum of 3.5 kgs to 5 kgs?

(A) Telangana
(B) Maharashtra
(C) West Bengal
(D) Delhi

Q.21
Which of the following groupsconsists of elements that are non-reactive, monoatomic elements with extremely low boiling points?

(A) Group 18
(B) Group 16
(C) Group 15
(D) Group 13

Q.22
Which of the following books is an autobiography of the Indian constitutional jurist Fali S Nariman?

(A) Courage and Commitment
(B) Before Memory Fades: An Autobiography
(C) Wandering in Many Worlds
(D) All From Memory: An Autobiography

Q.23
Which of the following is a mountain pass in the Pir Panjal range at a maximum altitude of 2832 metresthat connects the Kashmir Valley in the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir with the Outer Himalayas and the plains in the south?

(A) Mana Pass
(B) Banihal Pass
(C) Bara-Lacha Pass
(D) Zoji La

Q.24
‘I, Me, Mine’ is the autobiography of which international musician?

(A) George Harrison
(B) Justin Bieber
(C) AR Rahman
(D) Elton John

Q.25
Identify the cell that is amoeboid in shape.

(A) Nerve cell
(B) Columnar epithelial cell
(C) Red blood cell
(D) White blood cell

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(C)**
Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(D)**	

General Intelligence

Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**
Q.9 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(D)**
Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(D)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(C)**
Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(C)**		

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (B) more creative

SSC's key gives 'more creative': to win, one has to be more creative than the other entrants. The superlative would need 'the' ('the most creative'), and 'creativest' and 'creativer' are not used, as long adjectives take 'more' and 'most'. The sentence as printed is also correct, but no option keeps it.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Perpetual

'Perpetual' means lasting for ever, or continuing without end.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Charishma

The correct spelling is 'charisma'.

Q.4 · Answer (C) held out

To 'hold out' is to go on resisting an attack, as soldiers do for weeks; 'passed in' makes no sense here.

Q.5 · Answer (A) alter

To 'alter' clothes is to change them to fit; an 'altar' is the table in a place of worship.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Optimism

'Sanguinity' is cheerful confidence about the future: 'optimism'.

Q.7 · Answer (C) scent

A perfume has a 'scent'; 'sent' and 'cent' only sound the same.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Everybody in the family is going to admire the new bride.

'Is going to be admired by everyone' becomes 'Everybody is going to admire': the same future form, with the agent as subject.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Extravagant

Someone who spends money wastefully on luxuries is 'extravagant'.

Q.10 · Answer (D) A person who can be trusted to do something efficiently

A 'safe pair of hands' is a person who can be relied on to do a job well.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Cosmopolitan

A 'cosmopolitan' outlook draws on people and cultures from all over the world.

Q.12 · Answer (D) The airport security refused him admittance.

The simple past passive 'was refused' becomes the simple past active 'refused', with the airport security as subject.

Q.13 · Answer (B) that she can use my car to get around

'Could have' needs a past participle, so 'could have use' is wrong; 'can use' fits 'while she is in my hometown'. To 'get around' is to travel about; to 'get away' is to escape.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Eminent people were presented awards by the government.

The simple past 'presented' becomes the simple past passive 'were presented', with 'eminent people' as subject.

Q.17 · Answer (A) successful

The correct spelling is 'successful'.

Q.18 · Answer (D) CDAB

C opens with Mr. Dursley's strange day, D tells of the meeting outside his home that night, A gives Dumbledore's news to McGonagall and B ends with Harry left at the door: CDAB.

Q.19 · Answer (A) exhausted

To 'expend' savings is to use them up: 'exhausted'.

Q.20 · Answer (C) To fail
To 'let someone down' is to fail them, to disappoint them.

Q.21 · Answer (B) showing
Trust is 'showing' confidence, faith and hope in someone, as the next sentence's 'ways to show trust' confirms.

Q.22 · Answer (B) honest
To be trusted, 'just be honest'.

Q.23 · Answer (C) break
Trust takes years to build and seconds to 'break', set against 'forever to repair'.

Q.24 · Answer (A) broken
A mirror can be fixed if 'broken', but the cracks still show in the reflection.

Q.25 · Answer (D) bonds
Friendships and relationships are 'bonds', and all of them rest on trust.

General Intelligence

Q.2 · Answer (B) OTSSRE
The first two letters swap, the middle pair moves 3 places forward and the last two swap: SO CC ER → OS FF RE and RO LL ER → OR OO RE. So TO PP ER → OT SS RE: OTSSRE.

Q.3 · Answer (A) 33
After replacing the letters: (40 ÷ 4) × 5 + (3 × 6) – (7 × 8) + 21 = 50 + 18 – 56 + 21 = 33.

Q.5 · Answer (B) 56
The second number is 6 times the first minus 16: 6 × 5 – 16 = 14 and 6 × 17 – 16 = 86. Likewise 6 × 12 – 16 = 56.

Q.6 · Answer (B) 261924
Consonants are written as twice their place in the alphabet and vowels as their place: H(16) E(5) L(24) P(32) and S(38) A(1) V(44) E(5). So M(26) A(1) I(9) L(24): 261924.

Q.7 · Answer (A) 13 : 28.5
In 15 : 32.5, 19 : 38.5 and 17 : 35.5 the second number is 1.5 times the first plus 10 (22.5 + 10, 28.5 + 10, 25.5 + 10). 13 × 1.5 + 10 = 29.5, not 28.5, so 13 : 28.5 is the odd one.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Husband’s sister
R is K's only son, so his sibling N is K's daughter; S, K's only daughter-in-law, is R's wife. N is therefore S's husband's sister.

Q.9 · Answer (C) (66, 6, 17)
First ÷ second + second = third: 56 ÷ 8 + 8 = 15 and 32 ÷ 16 + 16 = 18. Likewise 66 ÷ 6 + 6 = 17.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Only conclusion III follows.
All ants are beetles and no beetle is a frog, so no ant is a frog (III). The bugs that are frogs are not beetles, but other bugs may or may not be beetles or ants, so neither I nor II follows.

Q.12 · Answer (C) 100 : 9
The second number is 2 less than the square root of the first: √25 – 2 = 3, √64 – 2 = 6 and √81 – 2 = 7. √100 – 2 = 8, not 9, so 100 : 9 is the odd one.

Q.15 · Answer (B) 151820197
Each letter is written as its place counted from Z (Z = 1, A = 26): W(4) A(26) V(5) E(22) and S(8) O(12) U(6) N(13) D(23). So L(15) I(18) G(20) H(19) T(7): 151820197.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Saturday
Counting odd days: 2000 years give 0 and 2001 gives 1; then January gives 3, February (28 days) 0 and 9 days of March 2. 1 + 3 + 0 + 2 = 6 odd days, which is Saturday.

Q.17 · Answer (D) DHPD
First letters move +9 (T, C, L, U, so D), second letters +8 (B, J, R, Z, so H), third letters +7 (N, U, B, I, so P) and fourth letters +6 (F, L, R, X, so D), wrapping round the alphabet: DHPD.

Q.18 · Answer (C) ×,−,=, ×,−,÷,+
39 × 4 − 61 = 18 × 4 − 49 ÷ 7 + 30: the left side is 156 − 61 = 95 and the right side 72 − 7 + 30 = 95.

Q.19 · Answer (B) 41
In each row, 2 × first + middle = third: 2 × 17 + 26 = 60 and 2 × 8 + 15 = 31. So 2 × 11 + 19 = 41.

Q.20 · Answer (D) ×, =, ×, ×, −, ×
50 × 2 = 3 × 30 × 10 − 40 × 20: the left side is 100 and the right side 900 − 800 = 100.

Q.21 · Answer (A) 24 : 8
In 16 : 4, 48 : 12 and 20 : 5 the second number is a quarter of the first. In 24 : 8 it is a third, so that pair is the odd one.

Q.22 · Answer (C) 5925
The steps alternate: +5, ×10, +15, ×20, so next +25: 5900 + 25 = 5925.

Q.23 · Answer (D) HPQE
The letters move +2, −2, +2, −2: DUCK → FSEI and FISH → HGUF. So FROG → HPQE.

Q.25 · Answer (B) o o J o o N J o o
With o, o, J, o, o, N, J, o, o in the blanks the block oMoNoJo repeats: oMoNoJo oMoNoJo oMoNoJo.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.4 · Answer (D) 9
The third proportional to a and b is b^2/a: $27^2/81 = 729/81 = 9$.

Q.5 · Answer (C) 15%
After 10% off, ₹3,200 becomes ₹2,880. ₹2,448/₹2,880 = 0.85, so the second discount is 15%.

Q.8 · Answer (A) 20000
With N voters enrolled, 0.9N voted and 0.95 × 0.9N = 0.855N votes were valid. The winner's margin is 55% − 45% = 10% of these: 0.0855N = 1,710, so N = 20,000.

Q.9 · Answer (C) 10.68 cm
65% of the volume of 15 balls remains: $(4/3)\pi R^3 = 0.65 \times 15 \times (4/3)\pi \times 5^3$, so $R^3 = 1{,}218.75$ and R ≈ 10.68 cm.

Q.11 · Answer (D) 4 times
SSC's key gives 4 times, taking 'increase by how many times' to mean how many times as large the area becomes: from $5^2 = 25$ cm² to $10^2 = 100$ cm². Read strictly, the increase is 75 cm², 3 times the original area, which is also an option.

Q.12 · Answer (B) 64
Take 100 km: 60 km at 60 km/h takes 1 hour and 40 km at 70 km/h takes 4/7 hour. Average speed = 100 ÷ 11/7 = 700/11 ≈ 63.6 km/h, which rounds to 64.

Q.14 · Answer (D) ₹11,220
Cost × 1.11 × 1.15 × 1.19 = ₹17,045, so the cost is 17,045 ÷ 1.519035 ≈ ₹11,220.9; the integral part is ₹11,220.

Q.15 · Answer (B) 21
(60 × 15 + 40 × 30)/100 = (900 + 1,200)/100 = 21.

Q.17 · Answer (C) ₹6991
Six weeks at ₹8,500 need ₹51,000. The five weeks total ₹44,009, so the sixth must bring ₹51,000 − ₹44,009 = ₹6,991.

Q.18 · Answer (A) 5
90 − 72 = 18 km/h = 18 × 5/18 = 5 m/s.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Rs 4,08,895.2
₹4,88,000 × 0.90 = ₹4,39,200; × 0.95 = ₹4,17,240; × 0.98 = ₹4,08,895.2.

Q.20 · Answer (C) 3
$a^2 + b^2 + c^2 - ab - bc - ca = \frac{1}{2}[(a-b)^2 + (b-c)^2 + (c-a)^2] = \frac{1}{2}(1 + 1 + 4) = 3$.

Q.22 · Answer (D) ₹99
CI = 5,000 × $(1.08^3 - 1)$ = 5,000 × 0.259712 = ₹1,298.56 and SI = 5,000 × 8 × 3/100 = ₹1,200. The difference, ₹98.56, is ₹99 to the nearest rupee.

Q.23 · Answer (D) 8 m
The radius is 5 m, so the 8 m chord is $\sqrt{(5^2 - 4^2)} = 3$ m from the centre. The other chord, 6 m away, cannot be on the same side (9 m > 5 m), so it is 3 m from the centre on the other side and also 2 × 4 = 8 m long.

Q.24 · Answer (A) 3
$3 \times 1^2 + 2 \times \frac{1}{2} - 2 \times \frac{1}{2} = 3 + 1 - 1 = 3$.

Q.25 · Answer (C) 16.7%
To keep spending the same, consumption must fall by 20/120 = 1/6 ≈ 16.7%.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) Vandana Katariya
In August 2021 hockey player Vandana Katariya was named the brand ambassador of 'Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao' for her home district, Haridwar.

Q.2 · Answer (A) 42.195 km
The marathon is run over 42.195 km.

Q.3 · Answer (A) AR Rahman
A. R. Rahman won two Grammys in 2010 for 'Slumdog Millionaire': for the soundtrack album and for the song 'Jai Ho'.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Zakir Hussain
Zakir Hussain is known for the tabla; Hariprasad Chaurasia for the flute, Sultan Khan for the sarangi and Amjad Ali Khan for the sarod.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Gallium
Mendeleev left a gap below aluminium for 'eka-aluminium'; gallium, discovered in 1875, filled it with the properties he had predicted.

Q.6 · Answer (D) 2018
POSHAN Abhiyaan, the National Nutrition Mission, was launched in March 2018 at Jhunjhunu, Rajasthan.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Bhupen Hazarika
SSC's key gives Bhupen Hazarika, the 'Bard of the Brahmaputra', who composed the music of 'Rudaali' (1993). His award for that score was the best-music prize of the 1993 Asia-Pacific Film Festival; his National Award for Best Music Direction was for 'Chameli Memsaab' (1975).

Q.8 · Answer (B) Dhrupad
Ashish Sankrityayan is a dhrupad singer trained by the Dagars, who took charge of the Dhrupad Kendra in Bhopal in 2011.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Munshi Premchand
'Godan' (1936), the story of the poor farmer Hori, was Munshi Premchand's last completed novel.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Kelucharan Mohapatra
Guru Kelucharan Mohapatra, a Padma Vibhushan, led the twentieth-century revival of Odissi.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Germanium
Ge is the symbol of germanium; gallium is Ga, gold Au and gadolinium Gd.

Q.12 · Answer (B) 85%
SSC's key gives 85% as the share of the rural population using safe and functional toilets in the 2019-20 survey; analyses of the National Annual Rural Sanitation Survey quote the same 85% for rural use of functional toilets.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Oudh
Wajid Ali Shah, the last Nawab of Oudh (Awadh), was a great patron of Kathak at his court in Lucknow.

Q.14 · Answer (A) repo rate
The repo rate is the rate at which the RBI lends to banks for the short term against government securities; at the reverse repo rate it borrows from them.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Harvinder Singh
Para-archer Harvinder Singh, bronze medallist at the Tokyo Paralympics, received the Arjuna Award in 2021.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Five
Under Article 32 the Supreme Court can issue five writs: habeas corpus, mandamus, prohibition, certiorari and quo warranto.

Q.17 · Answer (B) 2019-20
SSC's key gives 2019-20: in November 2021 Madhya Pradesh announced its Rashtriya Kalidas Samman for the years 2019 and 2020, and the classical dance award went to Sunaina Hazarilal and to the Dhananjayans, the Bharatanatyam couple from Chennai.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Bipin Singh
Guru Bipin Singh opened the Govindji Nartanalaya in Imphal so that women from ordinary families could learn the Manipuri dance of the royal palace.

Q.19 · Answer (B) England
The first World Test Championship final, India v New Zealand in June 2021, was played at Southampton in England.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Delhi
In January 2021 Delhi's Directorate of Education told its schools to follow the School Bag Policy 2020, which keeps a bag within 10% of the pupil's body weight in classes 1 to 10 and sets limits class by class.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Group 18
Group 18 holds the noble gases: unreactive, monatomic elements with very low boiling points.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Before Memory Fades: An Autobiography
'Before Memory Fades' is the autobiography of the jurist Fali S. Nariman.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Banihal Pass
The Banihal Pass (2,832 m) crosses the Pir Panjal range between the Kashmir Valley and Jammu; the Jawahar Tunnel runs beneath it.

Q.24 · Answer (A) George Harrison
'I, Me, Mine' (1980) is the autobiography of George Harrison of the Beatles, named after one of his Beatles songs.

Q.25 · Answer (D) White blood cell

White blood cells are amoeboid: they change shape and move by pseudopodia, which lets them engulf germs.

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